Yet it carried over into his tutelage. He wouldn't scream at me if I got out to a poor shot; a look of piercing sadness was usually enough. He knew I knew what I'd done: why raise the temperature if you, as a coach, have faith that your pupil will respond? His most persuasive method of motivation was the quiet but telling one-liner.

For example, a big turning point for me was an early four-day second-team game against Warwickshire, with shortened boundaries. I was in decent nick, and 97 not out at lunch, with Swampy also unbeaten in an opening partnership of 160. Goochy, who had made a point of postponing his first-team duties for our match, sat us down, and said, 'Get yourself back in, don't give it away, and you've got a really big score.'

You're probably ahead of me here, but, sure enough, I had an airy drive at the second ball of the afternoon session, nicked it and was out. I was expecting a massive bollocking that never arrived, and had to watch, stewing in my own juices, as Swampy got 200. When he was dismissed, Goochy tapped me on the leg, whispered, 'He's just got your runs there,' and walked off.

Enough said.

Graham was old school. Hit the boundary, take a single off the next ball, and get off strike. You've got five in two balls. It's your partner's turn to take the strain. Simple enough advice to absorb, you'd think, but young players are prone to brain fades and rushes of blood. They unerringly take the wrong option. Though he didn't show it, it must have driven him mad.

I was sitting next to him, as twelfth man, during a T20 quarter-final at Leicester. Graham Napier, our pinch hitter, was batting at three. When he hit his second ball for six Goochy murmured, 'Great shot, great shot. Now get a single. You've done your job, Napes. Don't do anything stupid.' Needless to say, he got out to a huge slog at the next delivery.

Goochy looked in a world of pain. 'Wanker!' he exclaimed, in that reedy voice, which seemed to echo across the wilderness. I was desperate to laugh, because the emotion expressed in that single word was hilarious, but had enough common sense to keep schtum. When your coach is suffering for his art, and your foolishness, silence is a shield.

It's a jarring expression, but you need someone to live the journey with you. A little luck doesn't come amiss. I was fortunate that Goochy was brought in by Andy Flower as England's batting coach, initially as a consultant in 2009, so that the relationship we had established at county